Week 1 Discussion

CSE 11 Fall 2026

Daniela Perry, Sydney Zhang

As you walk into class:

- **introduce yourself to the classmates around you and**
- **pull up the *~Discussion Section 1 Interactive Groupwork~* assignment on gradescope**
- **discuss your favorite song at the moment.**

Agenda

1. Introduction of TAs
2. What You Can Expect From Discussion
3. Content Review
4. Collaborative Activity (used for discussion attendance points)

Introductions – Daniela

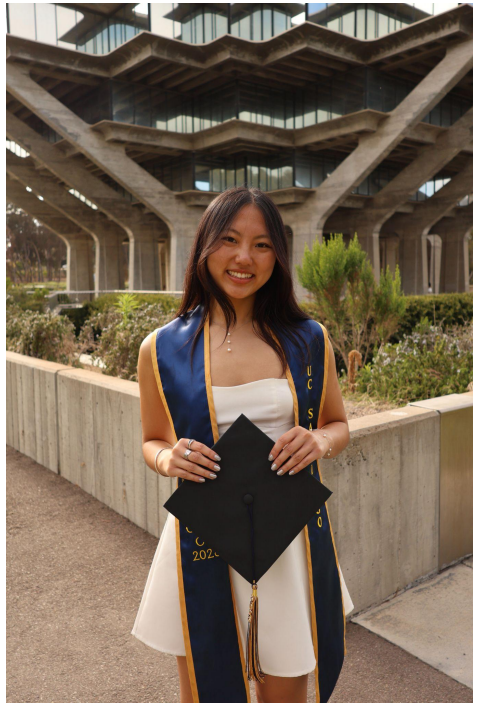


- Graduate Student
  - Bioinformatics PhD Candidate
  - wow 6th year already
- Teaching experience:
  - **CSE 6R** - Intro Python
  - **CSE 185** - Bioinformatics
  - **CSE 181** - Bioinformatics Algos
  - **CSE 599** - How to TA a CSE course
- **Office Hours:**
  - **Wed 11-12 CSE Basement 270A**

- Hobbies:
  - skiing
  - climbing
  - running
  - napping

Introductions – Sydney

- CSE Masters student (BS/MS)
- Previously a 4x tutor for CSE 11
- Hobbies
  - swimming + going to the beach
  - bullet + junk journaling
  - trying new restaurants
- Office Hours:
  - **Mon 3-4pm CSE Basement 270A**



What You Can Expect From Discussion

- Brief content review
- Demos and exercises that may help prepare you for the PA
  - No direct answers, but methods of thinking
  - We'd love to be interactive!
- A broad overview of this week's PA
  - Main components
  - Potential challenges

Note: we recommend going through the instructions of the PA before discussion section

- Miscellaneous materials that may help you better understand this week's lectures

What To Submit on Gradescope

- **This is important, please pay attention**
- Each discussion section will have its own submission on Gradescope
- These assignments will be open for submission **ONLY** during discussion section you enrolled in (+10min after grace period)
- Gradescope questions will **NOT** contain the questions asked in class, they will only contain spaces for your answers, and the questions will be discussed during discussion section
- It is **ILLEGAL** to share questions to students not physically present in class

Content Review

Variables: Types and Values

```
type variableName = value;
```

```
int x = 5;

double y = 2.0;

String s = "Hello" + " world!"; // expression using
                                // the + operator

Pict circ = new Circle(25, "blue"); // uses constructor
```

Naming Rules and Conventions

Rules

- Must start with a letter
- Must only contain letters, numbers, and a limited set of special characters (includes underscore)
  - Not allowed: my-number, 1string, hello!world

Conventions

- Record names: PascalCase
- Variable, parameter, definition, and method names: camelCase
  - Against convention: my_number, methodparameter, MyMethod

Method structure

```
returnType methodName([optional] parameterType parameterName, …) {
    method body;
}
```

```
int duplicate(int x) {
    return x * 2;
}

String greeting(String name) {
    return "Hello, " + name + "!";
}

void main() {
    method body;
}
```

Anatomy of the simplest Java program ever

- **main**: main entry point for the Java program
  - Example command to run a program called Example: `java Example.java`
  - Java looks for a main method in **Example.java** and starts executing there
- **void**: this method does not return a value.
  - English dictionary definitions:
  - **Noun:** A large hole, vacuum, or empty area, as well as an emotional feeling of loss or longing
  - **Adjective**: Lacking something completely, or having no legal effect (such as a null and void contract)
  - **Verb**: To cancel, nullify, or empty out.



Where is the bug in this code?

Each of the blocks of code to the right has a bug. Discuss what the issues are in small groups.

In questions 1-3 on the Gradescope discussion assignment, in the space provided, type:

- The line that the error will occur on
- What issue in the code will cause an error
- A brief summary of your group's discussion

Q1

```
1   void main() {
2       int age = 20
3       System.out.println(age);
4   }
```

Q2

```
1   void main() {
2       int number = "5" * 2;
3       System.out.println(number);
4   }
```

Q3

```
1   void main() {
2       string message = "hello";
3       System.out.println(message);
4   }
```

PrarieLearn / Running a java program tips

- **Ctrl + shift + C**: opens a bash terminal
- In most terminals
  - Click the up and down arrows to navigate through previous commands that you entered
  - option + click to move your cursor
- To run a program:
  - `java ProgramFileName.java`

PA0 - Due this Friday, October 2 @10pm

A tutorial exercise on running in PrarieLearn/Codespaces/your own computer

How to Get Help in This Class

- Piazza
- Office Hours (Professor)
  - First come, first serve
  - An opportunity to ask **conceptual/lecture-related questions**
- Office Hours (TAs and tutors)
  - Come to the CSE basement
    - The CSE 11 homebase will be in room B270 on most days–this is generally where you will find TAs and tutors
  - Create a ticket on Autograder
  - An opportunity to ask questions and get **unstuck** on programing assignments, not for solving the problems entirely

TODO

- Sign up for **exams**
  - https://us.prairietest.com
  - log in with your UCSD student account
  - join CSE-011 FA26
  - *Practice Test* that is optional - this week
- Submit **One Picture, Three Ways** worksheet to Gradescope before class **TOMORROW**
- Finish CH01,02,03 reading due before class **TOMORROW**
- **PA0 due Friday**

How to Get Help in This Class

Thank You!
Any Questions?